"How pleased I am to meet you." Then he said, "But tell me, what makes you think, just because you are the author of 'Nightfall,' that you have the slightest inkling of what is in it?"

And of course I couldn't answer that question because it suddenly became clear to me that there might well be more in a story than an author was aware of.

Dr. Guenther and I became good friends after that, and on October 17 I gave a guest lecture to his class. 9

21

I was already working on my share of the textbook, which we finally decided to call Biochemistry and Human Metabolism. My first job was Chapter 2, which was "Protein Structure." I worked away busily and discovered I enjoyed writing nonfiction but, alas, I had the same trouble I had with my dissertation. Writing became a committee affair.

After each chapter was done (and that meant endless looking up of references in the library, listing the important ones, constructing formulas, and so on), Walker, Boyd and I would go over the thing, word by word. It was even worse than my experience with Dawson.

For one thing, Walker and I were antithetical in style. I wanted to be chatty, colloquial, and dramatic; Walker wanted to be terse, formal, and cold. More often than not, Boyd sided with Walker, and it was not long before it seemed to me the textbook was more trouble than it was worth.

Having entered into it, however, I could not drop it, and I spent many months in the library, at the typewriter, and in conference. As much as possible, however, I did the work in school and left evenings and weekends free for my science fiction.

22

I couldn't very well forget my science fiction, for it was doing well. On October 17, I got my copy of the November 1950 Galaxy, the second issue, and it had "Potent Stuff" in it. Horace had changed the title to the totally unimpressive "Misbegotten Missionary." It kept that title through various anthologizations, but when the time came for it to be

9 By then, American troops had reoccupied all of South Korea and had begun